Mom's Deed, Policies and Account Papers in One Place

An organizer for families planning ahead: where each paper is, how recent it is, who holds it, and which ones haven't turned up.

The deed is in Mom's safe-deposit box, the life insurance policy is in a folder somewhere, and nobody remembers whether there's a trust.

This page doesn't ask you to read or understand any of it. Go through it with Mom when it suits her, and for each paper write where it is, the date on it, and who holds it.

WHAT TO COLLECT	WHERE IT IS	ITS DATE	WHO HAS IT
Deed to her home			
Latest property tax bill, and papers for any mortgage or loan on the home			
Social Security and pension paperwork			
Recent statements for checking, savings and investment accounts			
Recent statements for retirement accounts			
Life insurance policies			
Annuity contracts			
Papers for anything owned jointly with someone else			
Trust documents, if there is a trust			
Records of significant gifts, transfers or ownership changes in recent years			
If Mom is married: the same papers for her spouse			

What hasn't turned up yet, and who will look for it

Anything above with an empty line. Put a name next to each.

FOR EXAMPLE Nobody has seen the deed. Mom thinks it's in the safe-deposit box; she and Denise will look the next time they're at the bank.

Today's date, and when you'll go through this again

The page describes one day. Say which day, and pick a time to look at it again that suits Mom.

FOR EXAMPLE Filled in with Mom on a Sunday in October. We'll go through it again next fall, or sooner if something changes.

How to use it

- Write the date printed on each paper. If it has no date, write “undated.”
- Leave account numbers, Social Security numbers and passwords off this page. Just say where the paper is.
- Don't rewrite or summarize a document here, and don't move one without Mom knowing where it went.
- If nobody knows whether something exists, a trust for instance, write “don't know.” That's a finished line.

What this page doesn't do

It doesn't explain what any deed, policy, statement or trust means, and it doesn't say how any of them would be looked at if Mom ever applied for Medicaid. Rules vary by state, so those questions go to your Medicaid planner or the appropriate licensed professional. Nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You know where each of Mom's key papers is, who holds it, and which ones haven't turned up. The planning interview is the next step: it asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for care. Keep this page beside you while you answer.

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WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The second row follows documents the Administration for Community Living says a state may ask a homeowner for when someone applies for Medicaid. The rest come from the Medicaid Planning Roadmap's working list for this step.

1. Administration for Community Living (LongTermCare information), Applying for Medicaid